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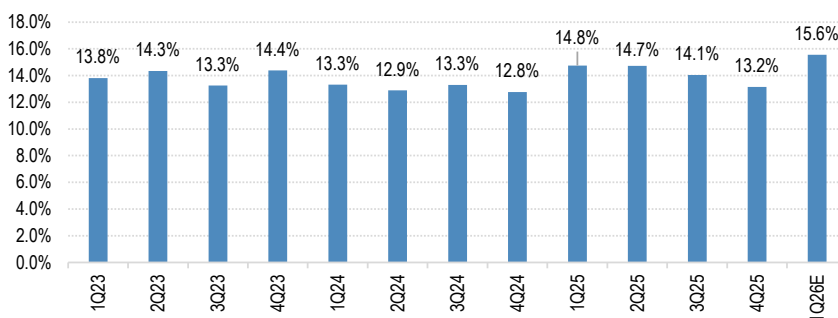
OCBC Bank

Small positive from BoNB results, risk-reward stays negative

Bank of Ningbo (002142 CH, covered by Haomin Chen) announced strong 1Q26 results. Net income grew 11% y/y with positive trends across NII (+14% y/y), fees (+82% y/y) and asset quality ([link](#)). The contribution of OCBC's 20% share is at 15.6% of our 1Q26E earnings, suggesting 1-2% upside to 1Q26E at OCBC (last 4 quarters' average contribution was 14.2%). While the outlook remains positive, CET 1 has declined 9bps q/q to 9.25%, with the buffer at only 150bps above the regulatory limit. This could limit the scope for growth going forward. BoNB previously announced a capital raise when CET1 reached similar levels ([link](#)), with OCBC contributing almost S\$500mn, or over 20bps of CET1 (2021, [link](#)). Yet, BoNB management has indicated a focus on internal capital generation (fee income, RWA optimization particularly IRB), which could lower the risk of capital raising in the near term.

We stay UW on OCBC heading into 1Q26 results (Friday, May 8). While WM should remain a bright spot, we expect provisions to be at the higher end of guidance and limited incremental announcements on capital return beyond its S \$2.5bn plan. Please see the preview table below.

Figure 1: BoNB: Contribution to OCBC profits



Source: Company reports and J.P. Morgan estimates.

Underweight

OCBC.SI, OCBC.SP

Price (24 Apr 26): S\$21.71

Price Target (Jun-27): S\$20.00

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Table 1: OCBC: 1Q26 preview

P&L (\$mn)	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26E	YoY	QoQ
Interest Income	5,410	4,994	4,824	4,847	4,758	-12%	-2%
Interest Expense	(3,065)	(2,711)	(2,598)	(2,551)	(2,484)	-19%	-3%
Net Interest Income	2,345	2,283	2,226	2,296	2,274	-3%	-1%
Non-Interest Income	1,310	1,264	1,570	1,320	1,568	20%	19%
Net Fee Income	546	580	683	602	722	32%	20%
Trading Income	458	458	576	492	525	15%	7%
Other Operating Income	306	226	311	226	321	5%	42%
Total Revenues	3,655	3,547	3,796	3,616	3,842	5%	6%
Costs	(1,415)	(1,389)	(1,519)	(1,559)	(1,484)	5%	-5%
PPOP	2,240	2,158	2,277	2,057	2,358	5%	15%
Loan Loss Provisions	(212)	(87)	(139)	(227)	(258)	22%	14%
Pre-Tax	2,297	2,301	2,412	2,113	2,395	4%	13%
Tax	(390)	(439)	(378)	(356)	(407)	4%	14%
Profit before MI	1,907	1,862	2,034	1,757	1,988	4%	13%
MI and EO	(24)	(46)	(56)	(12)	(30)	30%	150%
Core Attributable Profit	1,883	1,816	1,978	1,745	1,957	4%	12%
Reported Net Profits	1,883	1,816	1,978	1,745	1,957	4%	12%
DPS (\$)	-	0.41	-	0.58	-	n.a	n.a
Common Equity	59,416	58,299	57,813	60,294	62,234	5%	3%
Gross Loans	322,175	324,606	327,060	341,120	344,207	7%	1%
Net Loans	317,885	320,413	322,729	336,692	339,649	7%	1%
Deposits	402,732	406,943	410,596	428,286	437,014	9%	2%
NPLs	2,898	2,983	2,944	3,229	3,272	13%	1%
LLR	4,290	4,193	4,331	4,428	4,558	6%	3%
Change in bps							
NIM	2.04%	1.92%	1.84%	1.86%	1.82%	(22)	(4)
CIR	38.7%	39.2%	40.0%	43.1%	38.6%	(9)	(449)
LDR	79%	79%	79%	79%	78%	(121)	(89)
CASA Ratio	48.9%	49.8%	50.3%	50.7%	51.0%	206	22
Credit Costs (bps)	26	11	17	27	30	4	3
NPL Ratio	0.90%	0.92%	0.90%	0.95%	0.95%	5	0
Coverage Ratio	148%	141%	147%	137%	139%	(872)	219
Fully phased-in CET1	15.5%	15.3%	15.0%	15.1%	15.7%	21	62

Source: Company reports and J.P. Morgan estimates.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

OCBC Bank *(Underweight; Price Target: S\$20.00)*

Investment Thesis

We are UW on OCBC.

- The bank has built a multi-brand financial conglomerate in Asia, with Wing Hang, BoS, GEH and Bank of Ningbo being the main acquisitions/stake increases in the last 20 years, with Lion Global being a product of the merger between OCBC/GEH AMs. The group is generating 1.08% RoA with ~11x leverage in 2026E.
- The track-record suggests OCBC is more likely to use excess capital to buy rather than increase payout significantly. While management is committed to the current S\$2.5bn capital return plan, visibility for further increases in payout is low in 2026. Further, the bank's track record on inorganic growth could lead to near-term risks if growth is via inorganic means and transactions are not immediately accretive.
- We expect S\$1 DPS in 2026. This assumes 50% regular payout, as well as pay out of the remaining S\$780mn as special dividend. Beyond FY26, we expect the bank to sustain total payout close to 60%.
- The bank is benefitting from significant inflows of funds into Singapore, and in SGD. This should support NII, though reduction in credit spreads is a risk given macro uncertainties. We expect 1.77% NIM in FY26 vs. 1.91% in FY25.
- Risk-reward has turned negative following the stock price strength in last 1M. The stock is trading at 1.61x 2026E PB for ~12% ROE.

Valuation

Our Jun-27 PT of S\$20 is based on a fair P/B of 1.3x, assuming a normalized RoE of 11.9%, a risk-free rate of 4.1%, a cost of capital of 10.2% and a growth rate of 4.3%.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Upside risks include a significant improvement in DPS, a meaningfully value-accretive deal, better than-expected growth at GE, and better-than-expected WM fees. Bank of Ningbo (20%-owned by OCBC) has competitive advantages in local SMEs and high-net-worth retail clients, which could drive faster growth at the group.

Further downside risks include weaker-than-expected NIM, market-share losses in wealth management, lack of increases in capital return, and M&A, if transactions are not immediately accretive.

Companies Discussed in This Report (all prices in this report as of market close on 24 April 2026, unless otherwise indicated)
Bank of Ningbo - A(002142.SZ/Rmb32.30/OW)

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OCBC Bank (OCBC.SI, OCBC SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
13-Mar-24	UW	13.09	12.5
10-May-24	NR	13.91	--
13-Jul-25	N	16.89	18
08-Aug-25	N	17.09	17.5
10-Sep-25	N	16.76	17
28-Nov-25	OW	18.27	20
09-Jan-26	N	20.17	20.5
03-Apr-26	UW	22.38	20

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends. Initiated coverage Feb 24, 2000. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Bank of Ningbo - A (002142.SZ, 002142 CH) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (Rmb)	Price Target (Rmb)
17-May-23	OW	27.24	40.2
24-Jul-23	OW	24.70	38.4
10-Oct-23	OW	27.13	37.9
05-Jun-24	OW	24.21	30
24-Mar-25	OW	25.99	33.8
21-Apr-25	OW	24.60	32
10-Sep-25	OW	29.31	36.2
09-Dec-25	OW	28.18	35.8
23-Jan-26	OW	29.50	38.2

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends. Initiated coverage Mar 23, 2020. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

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